

IELTS Writing Band 7 Vocabulary Pack

Book 3 of 5 · Natural words and collocations that raise clarity

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Part of the Stratum IELTS Writing Guide Series

Series map

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How to use this book

1. Learn collocations, not isolated rare words.
2. Pick 8–10 items per topic and write your own sentences.
3. Reuse them in timed essays from Book 1 prompts.
4. Avoid forcing “fancy” words you cannot control.

Band 7 vocabulary is **accurate and flexible**, not exotic.

Contents

1. Vocabulary principles for Band 7
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1. Vocabulary principles for Band 7

Do

- Use precise common academic words
- Prefer collocations (*make a decision*, not *do a decision*)
- Paraphrase the question naturally
- Repeat key topic words if needed for clarity

Don't

- Memorise long idiom lists
- Replace every simple word with a rare synonym
- Invent words
- Use informal chat style (*gonna, kids, a lot of stuff*)

Upgrade pattern

Weak	Stronger (natural)
get better	improve / recover
big problem	major issue / serious challenge
many people think	it is widely believed that
good for society	beneficial for society
bad effect	negative impact / adverse effect

2. Topic banks

Each item: **word/phrase** — **meaning cue** — **example**

Education

- **academic pressure** — stress from study — *Academic pressure can reduce sleep quality.*
- **critical thinking** — analysing ideas carefully — *Schools should develop critical thinking, not only memory.*
- **equal access** — same opportunity — *Equal access to education remains uneven in rural areas.*
- **practical skills** — useful real-world abilities — *Practical skills help students prepare for work.*
- **lifelong learning** — learning across life — *Lifelong learning is essential in a changing job market.*

Work & economy

- **job security** — stable employment — *Automation may threaten job security in some industries.*
- **work-life balance** — time for work and life — *Remote work can improve work-life balance.*
- **skilled workforce** — trained workers — *A skilled workforce attracts investment.*

- **income inequality** — unequal pay/wealth — *Income inequality can weaken social trust.*
- **career prospects** — future job chances — *Internships often improve career prospects.*

Health

- **preventive care** — stop illness early — *Preventive care reduces long-term hospital costs.*
- **mental well-being** — psychological health — *Regular exercise supports mental well-being.*
- **sedentary lifestyle** — too much sitting — *A sedentary lifestyle increases health risks.*
- **public health campaign** — government health message — *Public health campaigns can change daily habits.*
- **life expectancy** — average lifespan — *Life expectancy has risen in many countries.*

Environment

- **carbon emissions** — CO₂ output — *Public transport can lower carbon emissions.*
- **renewable energy** — solar/wind etc. — *Investment in renewable energy creates new jobs.*
- **sustainable development** — growth without damage — *Sustainable development balances economy and environment.*
- **waste management** — handling rubbish — *Effective waste management starts with recycling habits.*
- **environmental awareness** — understanding impact — *Environmental awareness often begins at school.*

Technology

- **digital literacy** — ability to use tech well — *Digital literacy should be taught early.*
- **data privacy** — protection of personal data — *Stronger laws are needed for data privacy.*
- **technological innovation** — new tech development — *Technological innovation can improve public services.*
- **screen time** — hours on screens — *Excessive screen time may affect concentration.*
- **remote collaboration** — working online together — *Remote collaboration tools changed office culture.*

Cities & society

- **urban congestion** — city traffic crowding — *Urban congestion wastes time and fuel.*
- **affordable housing** — homes people can pay for — *Affordable housing shortages push workers outward.*
- **social cohesion** — community connection — *Local events can strengthen social cohesion.*
- **public infrastructure** — roads, transit, utilities — *Public infrastructure needs long-term funding.*
- **quality of life** — overall living standard — *Green spaces improve urban quality of life.*

3. Essay function language

Giving opinions

- I am convinced that...
- It seems reasonable to argue that...
- From an educational perspective...

Adding ideas

- A further advantage is...
- Equally important...
- In addition to this...

Contrast

- While this may be true...
- In contrast...
- That said...

Cause / effect

- This can lead to...
- As a consequence...
- One result of this is...

Examples

- A clear illustration of this is...
- This is evident when...
- Take, for example,...

Conclusion

- Overall...
- Taking these points into account...
- In summary...

4. Task 1 mini bank

- accounted for...
- the proportion of...
- a marked increase
- a gradual decline
- remained relatively stable

- overtook / was overtaken by
- the second highest figure
- by a significant margin

Pair with Book 2 for full Task 1 structure.

5. Practice drills

Drill A — Rewrite

Upgrade each sentence with natural academic wording:

1. Many people think online classes are good.
2. Cars make a big problem in cities.
3. Students get bad sleep because of exams.
4. Tech is changing jobs a lot.

Drill B — Build collocations

Write one sentence each with:

1. equal access
2. work-life balance
3. renewable energy
4. data privacy
5. affordable housing

Drill C — Essay transfer

Write a 250-word opinion essay on remote work using at least 8 phrases from this book. Then check it at stratumielts.com.

6. Next step

- Structure weak? → **Book 1**
- Charts weak? → **Book 2**
- Grammar errors? → **Book 4**
- Final polish? → **Book 5**

Vocabulary helps only when structure and accuracy are already solid.

Practice and score feedback: <https://stratumielts.com>

About this booklet

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End of Book 3 — Band 7 Vocabulary Pack · stratumielts.com